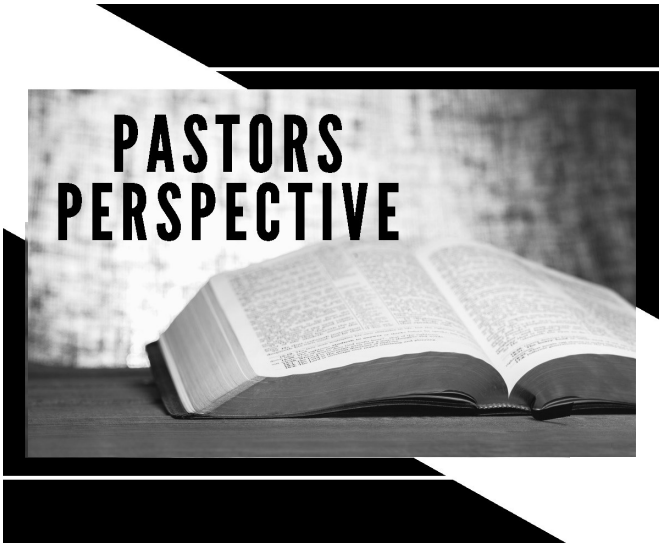
The Rocky Hock Anchor

The Mission of Rocky Hock Baptist Church is to magnify Christ and make disciples of all people.



"Write It Down & Close the Door"

"But thou, when thou prayest, enter into thy closet, and when thou hast shut thy door, pray to thy Father which is in secret; and thy Father which seeth in secret shall reward thee openly." ~ Matthew 6:6

During our Spring Revival, Johnny Foster challenged our church to find a prayer closet, shut the door, and give God our full attention. He went on to say that one of his favorite ways to talk to God during these times was to *write down his prayers.*

During his message on Monday night, he read one of the prayers that he wrote during the coronavirus pandemic. I was so touched by his prayer, that I decided to go home and write out my own… and I wanted to share it with you. It's from the heart.

"Lord Almighty, Creator and Sustainer of all things, Savior of the world, and of my soul… I profess my need for You today. I need Your strength and Your wisdom. I need the guidance of Your Spirit. And I need to hear Your voice. Speak, Lord. Speak to Your church at Rocky Hock. You said in Your Word that if we cried out to You, that You would show us 'great and mighty things.' We desperately need to hear Your voice. For all of our search committees, Lord — let them hear Your voice. Unify and guide them by the power of Your Holy Spirit and lead them to the ones You have chosen for our church. Lead them to people who will love and care for our congregation; show them the ones who love You with their whole heart, and who desire to glorify Your Name. In this time of waiting…. cause — by the power of the Holy Spirit — our congregation to fall more and more in love with your Word. Draw us to read it daily. Make the words leap off the pages in our minds like they never have before. I ask that you strengthen our church with unity and bless us with growth beyond any of our hopes or expectations. We long to see the house of God full. Fill it up with people who are ready to work for You. Give us a new, fresh burden for the lost. If there's anyone in our midst who isn't saved, I pray that You would draw them in; soften their hearts and let them see a need for salvation! Thank you for what you are doing in our church and in the lives of our people. You have been so faithful and so good and we love You. We want to hear Your voice and we want to see your hand at work in our church. We've already seen it at work and we want more! Grant these requests, O God. And send us a great revival."

It felt good to write all of this down. Johnny Foster was right. That said, I want to challenge you to write down *your* prayers this week. For your children. For your church. For your marriage. Whatever's on your heart… try writing it down. See if God doesn't just fill up your prayer closet with His Spirit like He never has before!

Trey Rogers, Senior Pastor

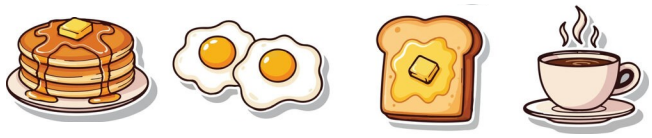
There will be a **CPR Certification Class on Tuesday, September 29th** at 6 PM, with a quick meal at 5:30 PM, in the Special Function Room. We currently have one opening left, for a max of 10 per class. We will also have a standby list, if needed. There is a fee for the class. Contact Rhonda Bass at 252-337-5766 if interested.

BAPTIST MEN'S BREAKFAST

The Baptist Men's Breakfast this month will be on **Sunday, May 17th at 7:30 AM** in the Special Function Room.

ALL WOMEN OF THE CHURCH ARE INVITED!

Please join us for food, fellowship, and a devotion! Be sure to sign up on a Connection Card or Sign-up Sheet.



We have great news! Rocky Hock Baptist Church will be hosting a Life Line Screening Event on **Wednesday, May 20th from 8:00 AM - 5:30 PM** in our Gym. Life Line Screening is the premier provider of stroke and cardiovascular disease risk screenings since 1993. They will identify your risk level by performing the tests listed below. Remember, a simple screening can be worth a lifetime! Make your appointment now by calling 800-324-9458.





Our next **Church Conference** will be on **Wednesday, May 27th at 7 PM** in the Sanctuary, followed by Prayer Meeting, if time permits. All Committee Chairs, or a representative from each Committee, should be present. If a report is to be given from your Committee, please contact the Church Office by phone (221-4133) or email (lbunch@rhbce.org) to have your name included on the agenda.

Youth and Children will follow the regular Wednesday night schedule: VSM (6th - 12th Graders) at 6:45 PM in the Youth Suite, GA's & RA's (Girls and Boys in 1st - 5th Grade) at 6:45 PM in the Special Function Room for a meal, Mission Friends (3 - 5 year olds) at 7 PM in the 2 year old Classroom.

THE YOUTH ZONE

AUTHENTIC WORSHIP

From: devotions4teens.com

Background Story: Colossians is a letter written by the Apostle Paul while he was imprisoned in Rome to the church in Colosse.

Read: Colossians 3:12-17
12 Therefore, as God's chosen people, holy and dearly loved, clothe yourselves with compassion, kindness, humility, gentleness and patience. 13 Bear with each other and forgive one another if any of you has a grievance against someone. Forgive as the Lord forgave you. 14 And over all these virtues put on love, which binds them all together in perfect unity.
15 Let the peace of Christ rule in your hearts, since as members of one body you were called to peace. And be thankful. 16 Let the message of Christ dwell among you richly as you teach and admonish one another with all wisdom through psalms, hymns, and songs from the Spirit, singing to God with gratitude in your hearts. 17 And whatever you do, whether in word or deed, do it all in the name of the Lord Jesus, giving thanks to God the Father through him.

Big Idea: Authentic worship is not words we sing but the life we live.

We've all had a "friend" that is nice to our face, but acts differently when they are around other people. This fake friendship doesn't sit well with us because we know that true friendship is more than just words. It requires consistency. Worship is like that. In Isaiah 29:23 God says, "These people come near to me with their mouth and honor me with their lips, but their hearts are far from me. Their worship of me is based on merely human rules they have been taught."

Worship is an expression of adoration and it can be easy to think worship only occurs when the band is playing at church. But authentic worship is way more than the words we sing during a church or youth group service. Worship is a lifestyle.

In Romans 12:1 we read, "Therefore, I urge you, brothers and sisters, in view of God's mercy, to offer your bodies as a living sacrifice, holy and pleasing to God—this is your true and proper worship."

Therefore, in remembering and considering all that Christ has done for you, offer your whole self as worship. We worship by clothing ourselves with "compassion, kindness, humility, gentleness and patience" and by forgiving others "as the Lord forgave you." We worship when we express thankfulness, love the unlovable, financially give, and serve others "in the name of the Lord Jesus."

Let's not leave our worship in our seat at church. Let's express adoration to God in our quiet moments with Him, in the halls at school, in our relationships, in how we spend our time, in our speech, and how we serve others. Before we move on with our day, let's take an unfiltered selfie of our heart. What is our worship like? Is our worship merely words we say or is our heart devoted to Him? Take that unfiltered heart selfie to God today in prayer.

Takeaway Verse: Romans 12:1
"Therefore, I urge you, brothers and sisters, in view of God's mercy, to offer your bodies as a living sacrifice, holy and pleasing to God — this is your true and proper worship."

Song for Today: That's Who I Praise by Brandon Lake

ATTENTION: GRADUATES!

Graduate Sunday 2026 will be on May 31st!



There will be a Graduates Breakfast on Sunday, May 31st at 9 AM in the Special Function Room and our High School and College Graduates will be recognized during the 11 AM Worship Service. The Youth Ministry Team will be reaching out with more information on the breakfast, as well as the specifics regarding the Worship Service.

We look forward to celebrating a joyous Graduate Sunday with all of our Graduates and their families!

Baptist Women

Pray for a Willingness to Be Redirected

from Missions Mosaic, Spring 2026

by Allison Nickels who is a graduate of New Orleans Baptist Theological Seminary with a Master's Degree in Ministry to Women

I have prayed for certain outcomes many times. Even though I poured my heart out, I felt God wasn't answering me the way I wanted Him to. I questioned whether He was listening. I even doubted whether He was there. I was mad at God. However, I soon realized my error. God did not need to conform to *my* will. I needed to expand my perspective to understand and accept *His* will.

WHY SHOULD WE PRAY FOR WHAT GOD WANTS?

King Solomon, the likely author of Proverbs, wrote, "To humans belong the plans of the heart, but from the Lord comes the proper answer of the tongue" (Proverbs 16:1). Simply stated, we each have desires, but truth is from God. When we pray to God, we can be honest about our emotions, even when those feelings are negative. When I was mad about my situation, I voiced my frustrations to the Lord. Yet, like a good Father, He listened to my tantrums and continually guided me.

Pray. Cry out to God and tell Him what is really on your heart. God is big enough to handle your big emotions.

WHAT HAPPENS IF WE'RE WRONG?

Humans are inherently limited. Our perspective is minuscule, but we act on what we believe is true. Proverbs 16:2 says, "All a person's ways seem pure to them, but motives are weighed by the Lord." For example, picture yourself as a missionary on the missions field. You've been working in a certain region. Maybe the work is not going as well as you had hoped, or maybe it is going great and you cannot imagine ever leaving. However, you feel the Lord leading you to leave the place where you felt safe to transition to unknown territory.

Although changing plans may be scary, God calls us to humble obedience. Listen to His words of comfort and assurance: "Commit to the Lord whatever you do, and he will establish your plans" (vs. 3). The entire path may not be clear, but He will reveal the next steps when we do things out of love for Him and love for others.

Pray. Tell God about your plans. Ask Him to expand your perspective to help you find His truth.

WHAT IS STOPPING US FROM FOLLOWING THE LORD'S WILL?

Pride and other sins are the biggest barriers to our obedience to the Lord. Yikes! Proverbs 16:5 says, "The Lord detests all the proud of heart. Be sure of this: They will not go unpunished." A prideful person, simply put, overvalues his or her perspective, often holding it in higher esteem than other people's and even God's. When we do this, it closes us off to others because we become hyper-fixated on what we hold to be true while rejecting other viewpoints. Pride causes us to ignore the possibility of love, empathy, and understanding. Because sin is atoned for by Christ's sacrifice on the Cross, instead of responding with pride, we should respond by loving God and living faithfully for Him (vs. 6). Because Christ was our atoning sacrifice, we can turn from the path of destruction toward God's path of righteousness.

Pray. Where have you been harboring pride in your life? Ask God to show you if you are not sure. Repent and ask for forgiveness. Be specific!

BENEFITS OF FOLLOWING THE LORD'S WILL

Proverbs 16:7 says, "When the Lord takes pleasure in anyone's way, he causes their enemies to make peace with them." When we obediently follow His path, He creates harmony (even among enemies). A two year old instinctively hides when they have done something wrong. Similarly, we intuitively know when we sin. Sin has a way of affecting those around us, not just ourselves. What was once peaceful becomes chaotic. However, when we follow God's path, He creates peace.

God's path leads to quality, not necessarily quantity: "Better a little with righteousness than much gain with injustice" (vs. 8). When we allow ourselves and our perspective to be redirected, we make ourselves available to a more fulfilling life in line with God's perspective. We are not promised great riches, but we will have a lasing and peaceful relationship with God.

We plan based on our desires and perspectives, but God knows the path: "In their hearts humans plan their course, but the Lord establishes their steps" (vs. 9). Although planning out the next decade might seem more comforting, we need to remember that only God knows the next step we should take. Accepting this requires faith because we cannot see the whole path. However, when we commit our plans to Him, trusting Him with each step, we can rest assured we are headed in the right direction.

Pray. Take a moment to praise God for His omniscient power, His goodness, and His grace. Thank Him for how He has guided you and continues to guide you. Ask Him to reveal only the next step and to grow your trust to follow Him where He leads.

Deacon Ministry

Deacon Team of the Week

5/3/26 - 5/9/26
J. C. Forehand, Scott Noble, Mike Evans

5/10/26 - 5/16/26
Russell Byrum, Matthew Evans, Phil Smith

5/17/26 - 5/23/26
Adam Bunch, Ted Peele, Oscar White

5/24/26 - 5/30/26
Steve Evans, Roger Smith, Chris Turner

5/31/26 - 6/6/26
Donald Bass, Allen Peele, Sam Tynch

May Deacon Greeters

Senior Adult Building: Carroll Evans

Sanctuary Main Entrance: Oscar White

Connecting Corridor: Ruston Howell

Multi-Purpose Main Entrance: Scott Noble

LOVE GROW SERVE

May Ushers:

Neal Bass, Tony Bass,
Matthew Evans, Leon Hemmings,
Stanley Tynch, Bob Wallace

May Offering Team:

Adam Bunch (Chair), Wayne Bunch,
Carroll Evans, Phil Smith,
Paul Ward, Oscar White

May Counting Committee:

Mike Evans, Frank & Hope Gosser,
Billy & LouAnn Elliott

Stewardship

Sunday Attendance:	SS	AM	PM
3/29/26:	163	281	89
4/5/26:	192	457	(No PM - Easter)
4/12/26:	170	254	96
4/19/26:	166	292	168 (Revival)

Wednesday Evening Attendance:

3/25/26:	57	(Church Conference)
4/1/26:	95	
4/8/26:	85	
4/15/26:	72	

Edenton-Chowan Food Pantry

The request from RHBC this month is:

Pudding Cups





Children's Page

For children of all ages!

Baby Dedication - Mother's Day, May 10th



Married couples (at least one parent must be a member) who have had a baby born since last Mother's Day are invited to participate in our Baby Dedication Service during Morning Worship on May 10th. If you wish to be included, call the Church Office or email Linda at lbunch@rhbce.org.



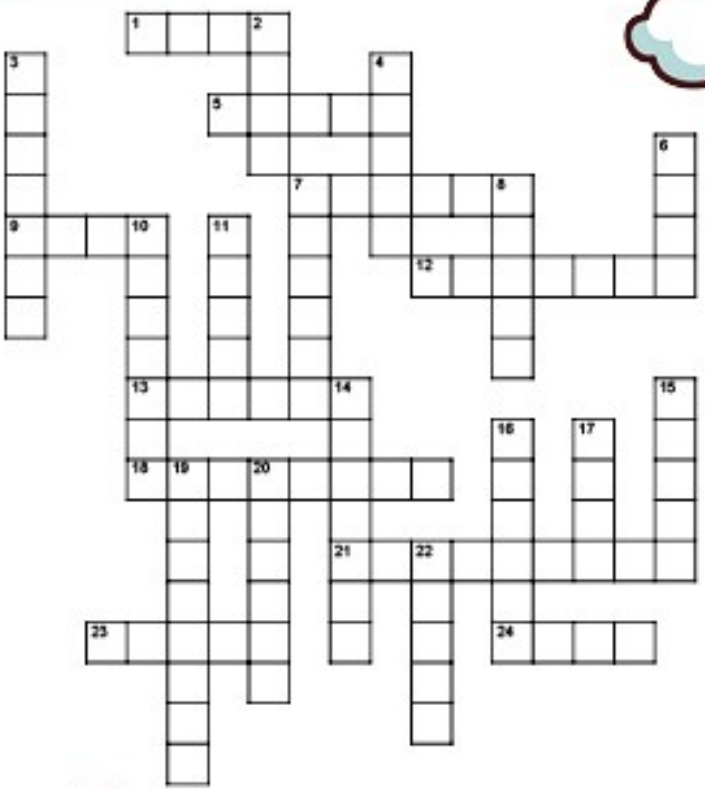
SUNDAES WITH MOM

A Children's Event to Celebrate Mother's Day on Sunday, May 17th from 12:30 - 2 PM

All Children (up to 5th Grade) and their Moms are invited to join in this fun time of fellowship! We will meet at 12:30 PM (after Morning Worship) in the Special Function Room for subs and chips and . . . an Ice Cream Sundae Bar! There will also be a devotional.

Spring is Here Crossword







ACROSS

1. Home for a bird.
5. Come out of an egg.
7. Meal in the park.
9. They make honey.
12. Flower on a tree.
13. A spring holiday.
18. It warms and brightens everything.
21. An adult caterpillar.
23. The color of spring grass.
24. What chicks hatch from.

DOWN

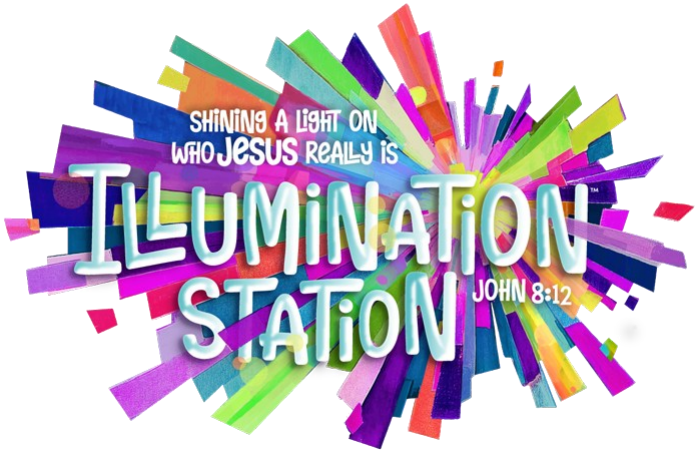
2. Warm up from a freeze.
3. Red insect with black spots.
4. A baby chicken.
6. Wriggly creature that lives in the ground.
7. Small pool of rain.
8. It might hide the sun.
10. Short rainfalls.
11. What the lawn is made of.
14. Colorful arc in the sky.
15. Another name for a rabbit.
16. Just a little wind.
17. It is green and on a plant.
19. It keeps the rain off you.
20. It comes after winter.
22. Flower from Holland.

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Vacation Bible School 2026
July 6 - 10 from 5:30 - 8:30 PM

At Illumination Station VBS, kids will be challenged to answer Jesus' important question to His disciples, "Who do you say that I am?" As they explore all the ways light brightens, illuminates, reflects, and reveals, kids will discover that Jesus is the light who brings hope to a dark world.

Jesus spoke to them again: "I am the light of the world. Anyone who follows me will never walk in the darkness but will have the light of life." ~ John 8:12



Rocky Hock Baptist Church
113 Rocky Hock Church Road
Edenton, North Carolina 27932

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Check us out on the web at www.rhbce.org

Weekly Schedule:

Sundays:
9:45 AM - Sunday School for all ages
11:00 AM - Morning Worship (Nursery & Children's Church available for 3 year olds up to 5th Grade); Worship Online at www.rhbce.org, our Facebook page, vimeo, and YouTube
6:00 PM - Evening Worship - ***"DEEP DIVE"*** - Adults in Sanctuary, Youth in Youth Suite, Children in Gym

Wednesdays:
6:45 PM - Vertical Student Ministries (VSM) - Middle & High School Youth - Youth Suite; GA's (1st-5th Grade Girls) - GA's Room, beside foyer; RA's (1st-5th Grade Boys) – RA's Room, upstairs (meal provided for GA's & RA's in Special Function Room)
7:00 PM - "**WORSHIP** *Seeds*" for Adults - Sanctuary; Mission Friends (3-5 year olds) - 2 year old Room

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Rev. Trey Rogers, Senior Pastor trogers@rhbce.org	252-687-2086 (Office) 706-994-2652 (Cell)
Mr. Steve Evans, Acting Music Director	252-333-8567 (Cell)
Mr. Allen Nixon, Chair of Deacons	252–312-7966 (Cell)
Mrs. Linda B. Bunch, Administrative Assistant lbunch@rhbce.org	252-221-4133 (Office)
Mrs. Donna Peele, Pianist	Mrs. Mary Jo Bass, Treasurer
Ms. Deborah Long, Custodian	Mr. Trey Bass, Security

Rocky Hock
BAPTIST CHURCH–EDENTON